

INFRASTRUCTURE

VARIABLES: Percentage of households with electricity, percentage of villages connected with pucca roads (surfaced + unsurfaced), road length/population, no. of bank branches/population, no. of domestic LPG consumers/total households, no. of post offices/population, no. of telephone connections/population

BIG STATES

RANK 2007		2007	2006	RANK 2005	2004	2003
1	PUNJAB	3.40	1	1	1	2
2	HIMACHAL PRADESH	3.40	2	2	2	1
3	KERALA	3.14	3	6	7	3
4	HARYANA	2.76	6	4	6	5
5	UTTARAKHAND	2.69	8	5	4	NA
6	MAHARASHTRA	2.69	4	3	3	6
7	TAMIL NADU	2.68	5	9	8	4
8	KARNATAKA	2.67	7	10	9	9
9	GUJARAT	2.65	9	7	5	7
10	ANDHRA PRADESH	2.58	10	11	11	10
11	JAMMU & KASHMIR	2.44	11	8	10	8
12	MADHYA PRADESH	2.08	12	13	13	12
13	RAJASTHAN	2.06	13	12	12	11
14	CHHATTISGARH	1.79	14	17	16	NA
15	WEST BENGAL	1.77	15	14	14	13
16	ORISSA	1.77	16	18	18	15
17	ASSAM	1.71	17	15	15	16
18	UTTAR PRADESH	1.68	18	16	17	14
19	JHARKHAND	1.52	19	19	19	NA
20	BIHAR	1.29	20	20	20	17

SMALL STATES

1	DELHI	4.61	1	1	1	2
2	GOA	4.58	2	2	2	1
3	PUDUCHERRY	3.24	3	3	3	NA
4	MIZORAM	2.94	4	4	4	NA
5	SIKKIM	2.86	5	5	5	NA
6	ARUNACHAL PRADESH	2.46	6	6	6	NA
7	MANIPUR	2.19	7	7	7	NA
8	TRIPURA	2.09	9	9	8	NA
9	NAGALAND	2.07	8	8	9	NA
10	MEGHALAYA	1.92	10	10	10	NA

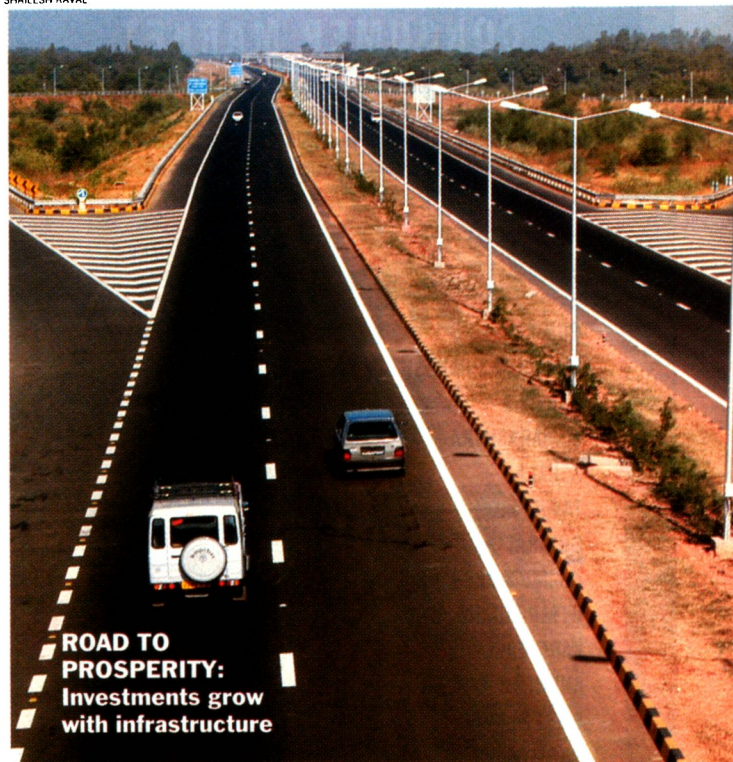
UNION TERRITORIES

1	CHANDIGARH	5.05	1	1	1	NA
2	LAKSHADWEEP	4.02	2	3	3	NA
3	DAMAN & DIU	3.08	3	2	2	NA
4	ANDAMAN & NICOBAR ISLANDS	2.96	4	4	4	NA
5	DADRA & NAGAR HAVELI	2.44	5	5	5	NA

Madhya Pradesh is the FASTEST MOVER

Fastest Mover is the state where the rate of improvement on overall performance between 2003 and 2007 was greater than the rate of improvement between 1991 and 2003

SHAIKESH RAVAL



ROAD TO PROSPERITY:
Investments grow with infrastructure

BIHAR HAS BEEN AT NUMBER 20 FOR FOUR OUT OF FIVE YEARS AMONG BIG STATES ON EIGHT PARAMETERS. JHARKHAND IS IN CLOSE COMPETITION.

dent of geography which places it in the delta region. But its performance is pathetic in areas like education where it is ranked 13, health (11), law and order (16) and infrastructure and budget management (15) in the large states. Any observer would be justified in asking why Kerala (where the Left ruled intermittently) ranks so high in health, education and law and order while West Bengal, where the Left Front has ruled uninterrupted, is trailing by such a huge margin.

Or take Bihar. It holds the dubious distinction of being ranked number 20 for four out of five years among large states on eight parameters. Jharkhand, a newly-created state, which inherited the industrially-developed parts of Bihar in the separation process, is in close competition. Worse, these states—barring Jharkhand—score less than one on a scale of 10 on critical parameters like agriculture, health, education and governance. To get an idea of how bad things are, let's look at some comparative figures. The average yield per hectare in Bihar is 1,535 kg compared to 3,943 in Punjab. It has just 62 affluent households per 1,000 in rural areas, which means only 62 households per 1,000 are in the Rs 690 to Rs 1155 and more income bracket and 122 households per 1,000 with incomes between Rs 930 and Rs 2,450 or more in urban areas. The comparable figures for Punjab are 509 and 393 households per 1,000 in rural and urban areas, respectively. Its literacy rate is 46 per cent and only 37 per cent of 10-plus children have completed primary education. Simply, a large section of the populace is outside the low threshold definition of what constitutes the affluent.